

UNIVERSITY OF IBADAN
Department of Estate Management

Assessment of the Maintenance of Public University Hostels in Nigeria

A case study of the halls of residence at the University of Ibadan

Submitted by

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Executive summary

This report presents the results of a 13-item questionnaire completed by 117 students who live, or lived, in University of Ibadan halls of residence between 21 and 29 September 2026. It covers the condition of hall facilities, how often key services fail, how faults are reported and repaired, how students view responsibility and governance, and how satisfied they are.

Students hold the university responsible for upkeep (86.3% agree), yet they rate facilities poorly (mean condition 2.66 out of 5), many wait a month or longer for repairs (46.2%), and 59.8% are dissatisfied overall. Toilets and bathrooms stand out: they have the lowest rating (mean 1.78), 65.0% of students name them as the single problem to fix first, and 78.6% rate them poor or very poor. Better-rated halls go with higher satisfaction ($r = 0.66$); crowding and gender show no significant link with satisfaction in this sample.

Table 1. Key results at a glance.

Indicator	Result
Respondents	117
Mean condition composite (Q5)	2.66 out of 5
Toilets and bathrooms rated poor or very poor	78.6%
Electricity failing four or more times a semester	68 students (58.1%)
Know where to report a fault (Q7)	81 students (69.2%)
Faults usually fixed within a week (Q8)	63 students (53.8%)
Wait a month or longer, or never fixed	54 students (46.2%)
Strong or very strong effect on health and rest	54 students (46.2%)
Dissatisfied or very dissatisfied (Q11)	70 students (59.8%)
Toilets and bathrooms as first priority (Q12)	76 students (65.0%)

1 Introduction

Student housing is a core service of a public university. Its quality depends largely on maintenance: how well facilities are kept, how quickly faults are fixed, and how clearly responsibility is assigned. This project assesses maintenance of public university hostels in Nigeria, using the halls of residence at the University of Ibadan as the case study.

1.1 Objectives

The questionnaire was built to meet five objectives. The study aims to:

1. describe the condition of hall facilities and how often water and electricity fail;
2. establish how maintenance faults are reported and how quickly they are fixed;
3. assess students' views on responsibility, rules, participation, complaint handling and funding;
4. measure the effect of hall conditions on students' academic performance and health, and their overall satisfaction; and
5. identify the problems students most want fixed.

2 Methodology

Instrument and sample. Data were collected with a 13-item Google Forms questionnaire between 21 and 29 September 2026. 117 responses were received, with no duplicate rows and no missing answers on the required items: 61 men and 56 women. Respondents were reached by convenience sampling, so the results describe this group and cannot be generalised statistically to all hall residents.

Coding. Five-point items were coded 1 to 5 (for example Very poor = 1 to Very good = 5; Strongly disagree = 1 to Strongly agree = 5). Breakdown frequency was coded Never = 0, Once = 1, 2 to 3 times = 2.5, 4 to 5 times = 4.5 and More than 5 times = 6. A *condition composite* is the mean of the seven Q5 facility ratings. Free-text answers on level of study (Q2) and top problem (Q12) were grouped into standard categories (Appendix B).

Analysis. Results are reported as counts, percentages and means with standard deviations and 95% confidence intervals (normal approximation). Relationships were tested with Pearson correlation (checked with Spearman), Pearson chi-square, and an independent-samples t-test. The analysis was run in Python (pandas, SciPy) in the accompanying notebook; an interactive dashboard presents the same results.

3 Results

3.1 Respondent profile (Q1 to Q4)

Respondents are 52.1% men and 47.9% women. Final-year students are the largest groups (500 level 33, 400 level 30). Time in the hall is spread evenly at the short end: 37 students have lived there under a year and 37 for one to two years. The most common room holds three to four students (54.7%), and **37 students (31.6%) share a room with five or more people.**

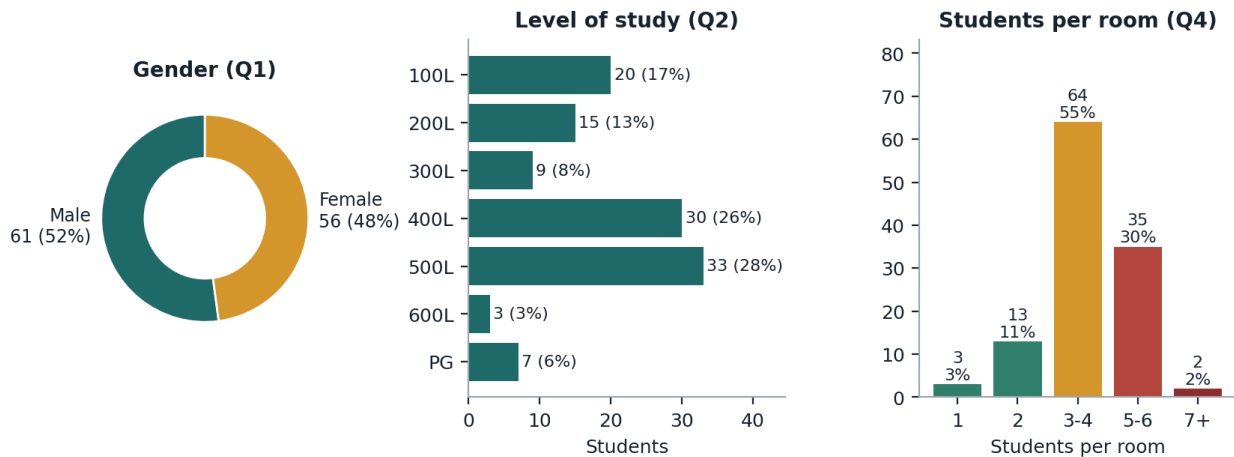


Figure 1. Respondent profile: gender, level of study and students per room.

3.2 Facility condition (Q5)

Toilets and bathrooms are rated lowest (mean 1.78, with 78.6% rating them poor or very poor), followed by plumbing and drainage (2.42) and cleanliness and waste disposal (2.47). The 95% intervals for these three lie wholly below the Fair mark of 3.0. Structural condition (2.85) is also below Fair, though its interval just reaches 3.0. Ventilation and safety (2.97) and water supply (2.99) are close to Fair, and their intervals include 3.0. **Electricity is the only facility rated above Fair** (3.18; interval 3.02 to 3.34). The overall composite is 2.66 out of 5.

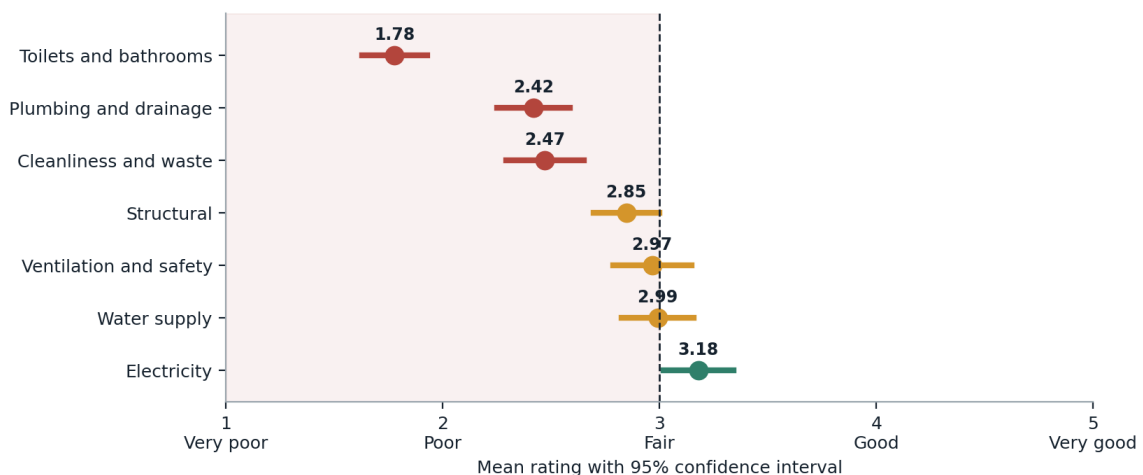


Figure 2. Mean condition rating by facility with 95% confidence intervals. The dashed line marks Fair (3.0).

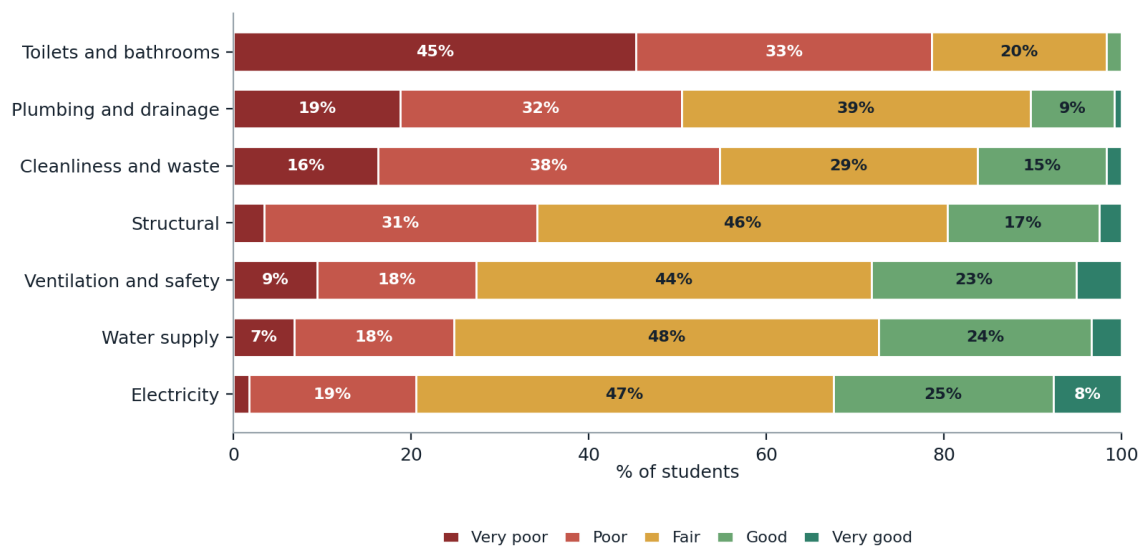


Figure 3. Distribution of condition ratings by facility, from lowest to highest mean.

Table 2. Facility condition ratings (n = 117), ordered from lowest mean.

Facility	Mean	SD	95% CI	Poor or very poor
Toilets and bathrooms	1.78	0.82	1.63 to 1.93	78.6%
Plumbing and drainage	2.42	0.93	2.25 to 2.59	50.4%
Cleanliness and waste	2.47	0.99	2.29 to 2.65	54.7%
Structural	2.85	0.84	2.69 to 3.00	34.2%
Ventilation and safety	2.97	1.00	2.78 to 3.15	27.4%
Water supply	2.99	0.91	2.83 to 3.16	24.8%
Electricity	3.18	0.89	3.02 to 3.34	20.5%

3.3 Breakdown frequency (Q6)

Failures are common. 68 students (58.1%) say electricity or lighting fails four or more times a semester and 55 (47.0%) say the same of water or pumps; 77 students (65.8%) report this for at least one of the two. 46 students (39.3%) report more than five electricity failures in a semester. Electricity therefore has the best condition rating but the worst reliability, which shows that a facility can be fair in condition and still unreliable in service.

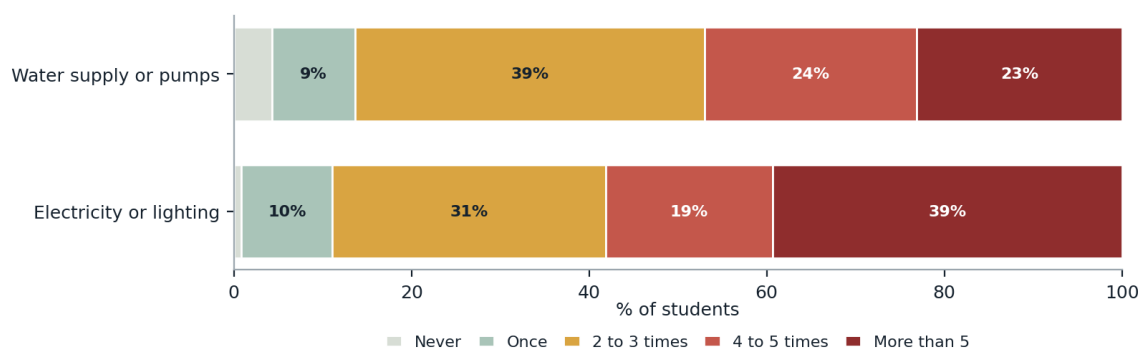


Figure 4. Breakdowns per semester for water and electricity.

3.4 Reporting and response time (Q7 and Q8)

81 students (69.2%) know the official person or office to report a fault to, while 36 (30.8%) do not. Repairs are usually quick for some and slow for others: 8 students (6.8%) say faults are fixed within a day and 63 (53.8%) within a week, but 54 (46.2%) wait a month or longer, including 18 (15.4%) who say several months or that faults are never fixed. The typical (median) answer is within a week.

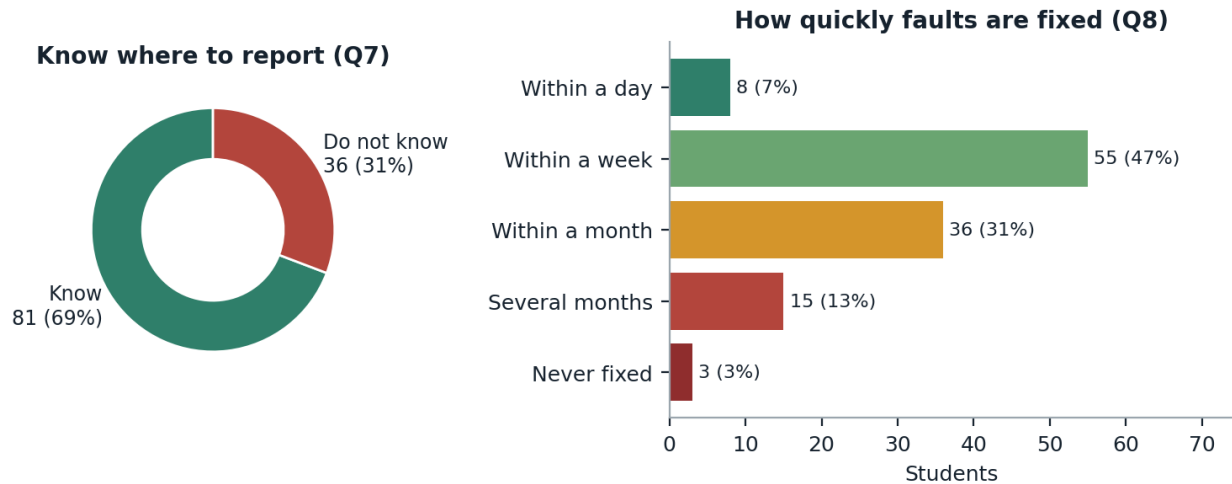


Figure 5. Awareness of the reporting channel and usual repair time.

3.5 Governance perceptions (Q9)

Students strongly agree that the university is responsible for hall facilities (86.3% agree, mean 4.40). Majorities also agree that students help monitor facilities (76.9%) and that rules with sanctions exist (69.2%). The weakest item is the complaint system: only 45.3% agree that a clear system for submitting and tracking complaints exists and 26.5% disagree (mean 3.17). Funding is the most uncertain: 39.3% are neutral on whether management has enough money, and 42.7% agree.

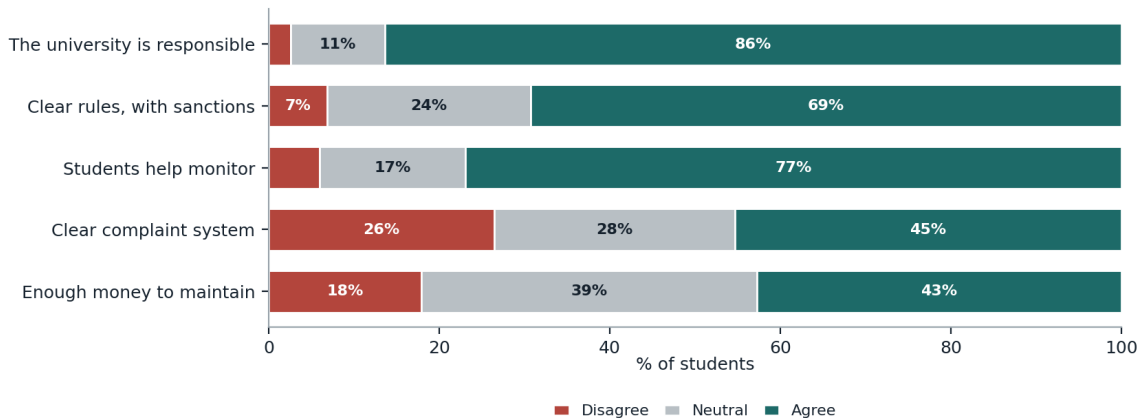


Figure 6. Agreement with five statements about hall management.

Table 3. Governance items, percentage of respondents.

Statement	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Mean
The university is responsible	86.3%	11.1%	2.6%	4.40
Clear rules, with sanctions	69.2%	23.9%	6.8%	3.97
Students help monitor	76.9%	17.1%	6.0%	4.03
Clear complaint system	45.3%	28.2%	26.5%	3.17
Enough money to maintain	42.7%	39.3%	17.9%	3.44

3.6 Effects on students and overall satisfaction (Q10 and Q11)

Conditions affect health more than study. 54 students (46.2%) report a strong or very strong effect on health and rest (mean 3.36) and 38 (32.5%) on academic performance (mean 3.01). Overall, **70 students (59.8%) are dissatisfied or very dissatisfied** with maintenance, 33 (28.2%) are neutral and 14 (12.0%) are satisfied (mean satisfaction 2.29 out of 5).

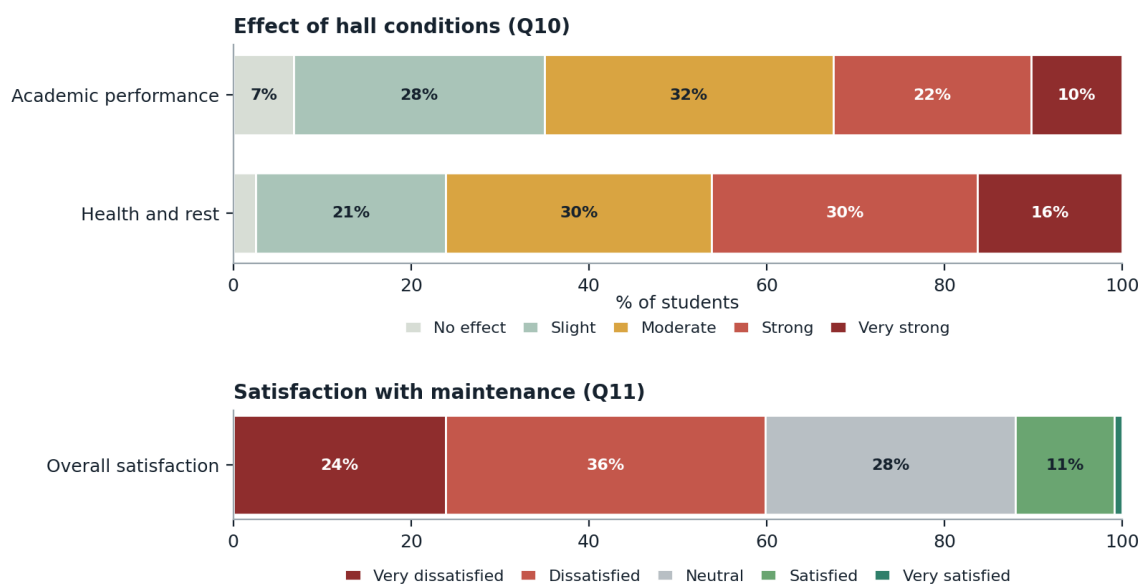


Figure 7. Effect of hall conditions on students, and overall satisfaction.

3.7 Priorities (Q12 and Q13)

Asked for the one problem the university should fix, **76 students (65.0%) chose toilets and bathrooms**. Water supply (8), electricity (6) and cleanliness and waste (6) follow far behind. 53 students explained why. The most frequent terms were toilets (20 mentions), bathrooms (16), water (10) and health (8), which matches the ratings and the reported health effect.

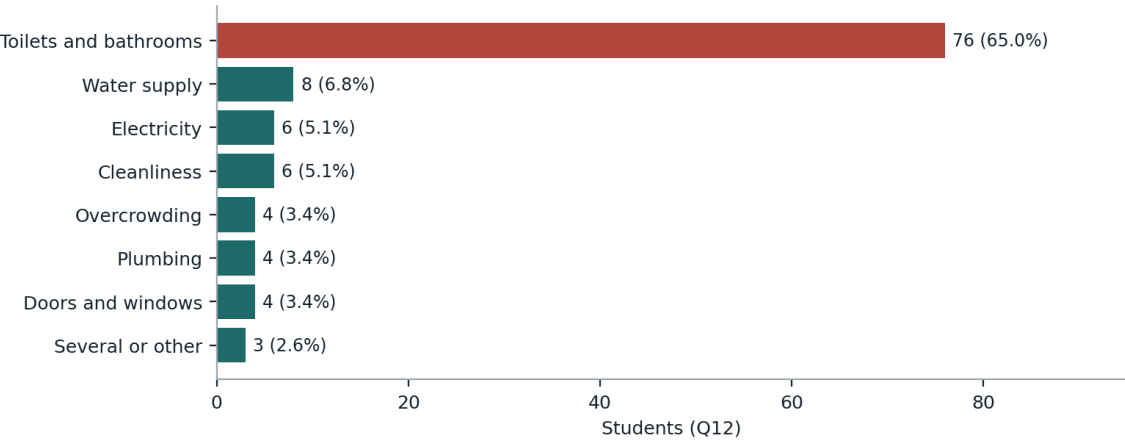


Figure 8. The one maintenance problem students most want fixed.

4 Cross-analysis

Condition and satisfaction. Students who rate their facilities higher are more satisfied. The correlation between the condition composite and satisfaction is strong and significant (Pearson $r = 0.66$, $n = 117$, $p < 0.001$; Spearman $\rho = 0.64$), so condition accounts for about 44% of the variation in satisfaction. This is an association; the survey cannot show that condition causes satisfaction.

Crowding. Mean satisfaction falls as rooms get fuller (from 2.46 in rooms of two to 2.14 in rooms of five to six), but the difference is not statistically significant. Comparing rooms of five or more with smaller rooms, $\chi^2(1) = 0.12$, $p = 0.73$; across all five groups, $\chi^2(4) = 1.60$, $p = 0.81$, though several groups are too small for that test to be reliable (only 3 students live alone and 2 in rooms of seven or more).

Gender. Men and women are equally dissatisfied: mean satisfaction is 2.30 for men and 2.29 for women ($t(115) = 0.05$, $p = 0.96$).

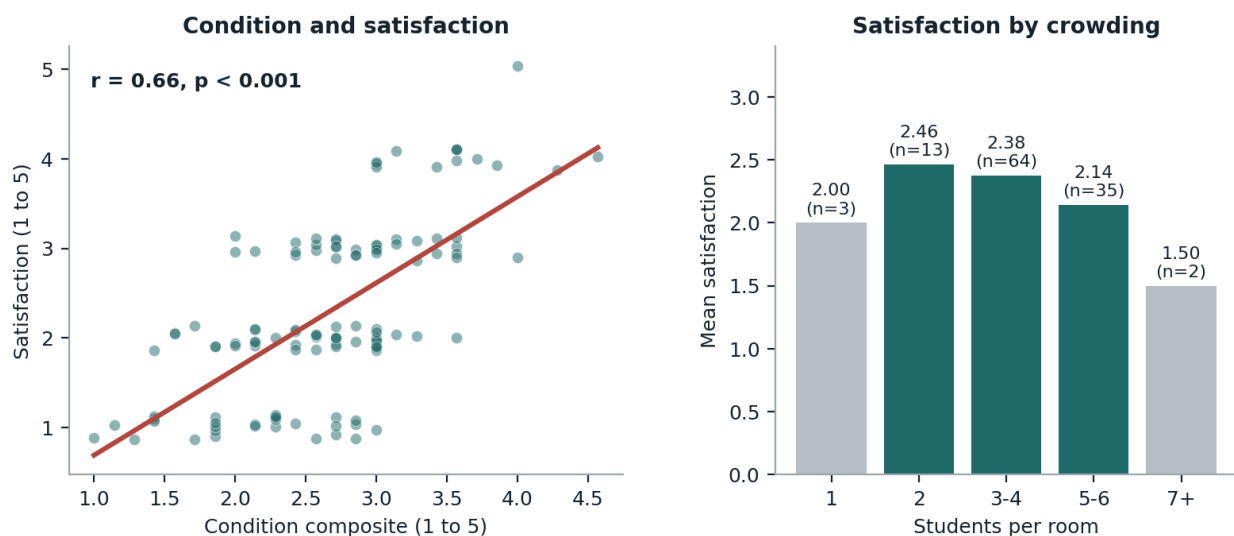


Figure 9. Left: condition composite against satisfaction (points jittered slightly for visibility). Right: mean satisfaction by room occupancy; grey bars have fewer than 10 students.

5 Discussion

Three patterns run through the results. First, **responsibility is not in doubt but delivery is weak**: 86.3% of students see maintenance as the university's duty, yet 59.8% are dissatisfied. Second, **knowing whom to tell is not the same as having a system that closes the loop**. 69.2% know the reporting channel, but only 45.3% say a clear complaint system exists and 46.2% wait a month or longer for repairs. Third, **shared sanitary facilities carry the burden**: toilets and bathrooms combine the lowest rating, the most first-place requests and a plausible link to health, the dimension students say is most affected.

These findings can be read against the perspectives used in the literature review. The high agreement on university responsibility fits a public-trust view in which the institution holds hostels on students' behalf. The poor state of shared toilets and bathrooms is consistent with concerns in commons theory about shared-use facilities, although this survey did not measure misuse directly. The willingness of students to help monitor facilities (76.9% agree they do) points to a stewardship role the university could build on. The weak complaint system and long waits are an accountability and service-standard gap of the kind new public management addresses. The survey evidence is perceptual, so these links are interpretations rather than tests.

6 Recommendations

The recommendations follow the strength of evidence in the data, in order of priority.

1. **Repair toilets and bathrooms first.** They have the lowest rating (mean 1.78), 78.6% rate them poor or very poor, and 65.0% name them as the top priority.
2. **Tell every student where to report.** 36 students (30.8%) do not know the official person or office; publish it in each hall.
3. **Set up a visible complaint system.** It is the weakest governance item (45.3% agree one exists, 26.5% disagree). A logbook or online form with a reference number and status would meet this.
4. **Adopt a repair-time standard.** 46.2% wait a month or longer. A target such as one week for routine faults, with reporting against it, would speed repairs and make delays visible.
5. **Treat electricity as a reliability problem.** It has the best condition rating (mean 3.18) yet 46 students (39.3%) report more than five failures a semester; investigate supply, wiring and load.
6. **Collect further evidence on crowding before setting an occupancy cap.** 37 students (31.6%) share rooms with five or more, but this survey found no significant link between crowding and dissatisfaction.

7 Limitations

The survey covers one university in one nine-day window. Answers are self-reported and halls were not physically inspected, so ratings reflect perception. Respondents were a convenience sample and may over-represent students with strong views, so participation bias is likely. Several subgroups (300 level, postgraduate, 600 level, rooms of one or of seven or more) are too small for reliable comparison. Findings are best treated as a well-grounded snapshot to guide further inspection, not as population estimates.

Appendix A: Respondent profile detail

Table 4. Respondent profile (n = 117).

Characteristic	Category	Students	%
Gender	Male	61	52.1%
Gender	Female	56	47.9%
Level	100L	20	17.1%
Level	200L	15	12.8%
Level	300L	9	7.7%
Level	400L	30	25.6%
Level	500L	33	28.2%
Level	600L	3	2.6%
Level	PG	7	6.0%
Years in hall	Less than 1 year	37	31.6%
Years in hall	1-2 years	37	31.6%
Years in hall	3-4 years	26	22.2%
Years in hall	More than 4 years	17	14.5%
Students per room	1	3	2.6%
Students per room	2	13	11.1%
Students per room	3-4	64	54.7%
Students per room	5-6	35	29.9%
Students per room	7+	2	1.7%

Appendix B: Coding of free-text answers

Free-text answers were grouped as follows. Where a response named several problems, it was coded to the first matching category in this order: toilets and bathrooms, water, electricity or wiring, overcrowding, cleanliness and waste, plumbing and drainage, roofing or leaks, doors, windows or locks, bedbugs, kitchens, stoves. Responses naming none (for example general complaints that everything is poor) are coded Several or other. Level answers such as graduate, graduated or M.Sc were coded PG.

Table 5. Top maintenance problem, all categories.

Top problem (Q12)	Students	%
Toilets and bathrooms	76	65.0%
Water supply	8	6.8%
Electricity	6	5.1%
Cleanliness	6	5.1%
Overcrowding	4	3.4%
Plumbing	4	3.4%
Doors and windows	4	3.4%
Several or other	3	2.6%
Bedbugs	2	1.7%
Roofing	2	1.7%
Cooking safety	1	0.9%
Kitchens	1	0.9%